# A listening corner for one Ace lobby.

EARF makes hi-fi and light in San Francisco, in cast acrylic tinted all the way through, in eight colors from Ember to Smoke. Tropos is a powered horn loudspeaker; Mantle, a record player whose plinth floats over a base lit at its edge; Hemisphere, a pendant; Core, a cordless table lamp. The first pair of Tropos played for the first time at our debut in San Francisco on 19 January 2027, in FOG Design+Art week.



RENDER · REPLACED BY A PHOTOGRAPH FROM THE DEBUT BEFORE SENDING

## WHAT WE PROPOSE

A season-long EARF listening corner in one Ace lobby: a numbered pair of Tropos, a Mantle record player and Hemisphere pendants, in a tint chosen for the room, with listening sessions through the season. It starts as a residency and becomes a purchase if it works for Ace. Beside it, an Ace × EARF edition of Core, our cordless lamp, for the rooms or the shop.

### WHY ACE HOTEL GROUP

- Ace has treated sound as part of the building: Devon Turnbull built the lobby system at Ace Hotel New York.
- Tivoli made a co-branded radio for Ace Sydney's rooms; Ace set the brief and the silkscreen.
- Elsewhere, hotels now commission listening rooms: OJAS's Listening Room at Patina Osaka; the Equipment Room at Hotel Magdalena, Austin, with Klipsch.
- A corner is smaller than a room: one season, one tint, no construction.

### ACE HOTEL GROUP BRINGS

- The lobby, and the guests in it
- The program: who plays, and when
- Its shop, for the Core edition
- Photography and its own channels

### EARF BRINGS

- The system: Tropos, Mantle, Hemisphere, installed and tuned
- The Sessions: one album, start to finish, on set nights
- Core in an Ace tint, numbered
- Service through the season

# How it could work.

An outline to discuss, not an offer. The ranges are those typical in published sources for licensed and co-branded design (furniture, lighting, consumer products); none of it is agreed, and every line is for counsel.

| TERM | IN OUTLINE |
|---|---|
| **Residency** | A season (about three months): EARF installs and services; Ace hosts and programs. A residency fee or a loan [to agree]. FOR COUNSEL |
| **Purchase** | At the end, Ace may buy the corner: 50% on order, the balance on installation, as commissions usually run. FOR COUNSEL |
| **Core edition** | Ace buys a numbered run (for example 100) at wholesale, about 40–50% of retail. FOR COUNSEL |
| **Co-brand** | "Ace × EARF" on the Core edition, under a license of 1–3 years; each approves the other's use of its name. FOR COUNSEL |
| **IP** | EARF keeps the design; a credit line such as "The Listening Corner by EARF". FOR COUNSEL |
| **Care** | Insurance and liability for loaned equipment in a public lobby; a service contract if bought. FOR COUNSEL |
| **Prices** | A suggested retail price for the shop only: no resale price set (California). FOR COUNSEL |

# When.

| FROM THE DEBUT | WHAT |
|---|---|
| **The debut, 19 January** | The pieces seen working, photographed |
| **2–5 weeks after** | This letter, with the photographs (February) |
| **About 12 weeks after** | A meeting in Milan, 13–18 April, or at the property |
| **Mid-2027** | The residency opens, in a city Ace chooses |
| **With the Core run** | The Ace edition of Core, numbered (est. fall 2027) |

### What we'd send next

Photographs and a short film from the debut; drawings of the parts we'd design; samples of the eight tints in cast sheet; an edition sheet with sizes, colors and lead times.

### What stays EARF's own

Tropos, Mantle and the tint system. An edition is designed around them and licensed for its own run; nothing here licenses EARF's products or its colors beyond it.

### Who

[Your name], founder, EARF, San Francisco. [contact line].
Through business@acehotel.com (Atelier Ace business inquiries); press@acehotel.com in copy.